

(Wireless Internet Protocol to mobile) will still be referred to as WAP is yet to be decided. XHTML MP (XHTML Mobile Profile), the mark-up language defined in WAP 2.0, is made to work in mobile devices. It is a subset of XHTML and a superset of XHTML Basic. XHTML MP supports a version of cascading style sheet called WAP CSS.

Other options in WAP such as WAP Push, available since WAP 1.2, have been incorporated into the specification to allow WAP content to be pushed to the mobile handset with minimum user intervention. A WAP Push is basically a specially encoded message, which includes a link to a WAP address. WAP Push is specified on top of WDP; as such, it can be delivered over any WDP-supported bearer, such as GPRS or SMS.

In most GSM networks, however, GPRS activation from the network is not generally supported. So, WAP Push messages have to be delivered on top of the SMS bearer. On receiving a WAP Push, a WAP 1.2 or later enabled handset will automatically give the user the option to access the WAP content. In this way, the WAP Push directs the end user to a WAP address where particular content may be stored ready for viewing or downloading to the handset. The address could be a simple page or multimedia content (e.g. polyphonic ring tone) or a Java application. Using WAP Push, one can make it easier for end users to discover and access new mobile services.

Though WAP was hyped at the time of its introduction, leading users to expect WAP to have the performance of the Web, it is widely believed in the industry that WAP has failed to deliver. One very glaring indication would be the disappearance of the courses started by computer institutes such as NIIT offering specialising in WAP. The failure to deliver has led to WAP being chided and newer acronyms such as “Worthless Application Protocol” supplanting the original acronym.